

Endowments

Chosen Ones: The Fomorians work in mysterious ways, but they appear to reward their devoted followers. Once per scene, a night marcher can add an extra success to any roll.

Fearsome: When marching, the huaka'i po gain a +1 bonus to all Physical rolls against non-Thallain. Higher-ups in the Shadow Court may make a vow in exchange for their own protection, but any non-Thallain being that looks at a night marcher provokes them into violence.

Vulnerability

Call of the Fomorian: Everything comes with a price, and being chosen by the Fomorians is no exception. These Thallain tend toward baser, more vulgar habits and find it hard to blend in among others, in urban areas especially.

Kelpies

Kelpies are most at home near lakes and rivers. Like their cousins the selkies, they can take on an animal form; instead of seals, kelpies prefer horses. Initially, these creatures seem kind and caring, and are quite capable of wooing others, but underneath this sweet exterior they are malicious and heartless beings.

Kelpies are drawn to bodies of water partly because of their proclivity for drowning their victims. They use their charm to trick victims into swimming with them, leading them out into deeper and deeper water before dragging them under. They can also use their equine forms to do this, charming the unwary passersby into riding them. Once mounted, they return to the water, dragging their victims with them as they dive below the surface.

Kelpies are solitary creatures, preferring to keep to themselves; too many in a small area is just asking for discovery. They coexist peaceably enough with other water-dwelling Thallain, but loathe the presence of changelings. They avoid selkies in particular, as their cousins can easily identify them as Thallain. If a kelpie has claimed a lake, selkies refuse to ever enter it. They can sense that it has somehow been tainted by a kelpie's presence.

Appearance

Always seeming to have stepped out of the shower or off the beach, kelpies carry the water with them. However, unlike their selkie cousins, they also carry a touch of the creatures of the deep ocean; their eyes are a bit too large, their lips thin, and they may bear some small amount of webbing between their fingers or toes. Their fae miens have fluttering gills and touches of bioluminescence. In their equine forms, they appear as normal horses on land, but once they step into water they develop fish-like tails instead of hind legs.

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Equine Form: By spending a point of Glamour, kelpies may shift into their natural shape. Any breed of horse or pony is possible, and the kelpie can maintain this form indefinitely. Changing back to mortal form has no Glamour cost.

Otherworldly Allure: In either of their forms, kelpies are almost hypnotically alluring. To use this power, the Storyteller makes a Charisma + Empathy roll, resisted by the target's Willpower. If the kelpie wins, the target mounts (or accompanies) the kelpie, and she can lead the target into the water and begin to drown him (see p. 293). After one turn underwater, the target recognizes the malicious attempt and can begin to fight back.

Vulnerability

Tack: If captured, kelpies can be bound in service to a master. The kelpie in question must be bridled, either in equine or human form, with enchanted equipment. Simple jewelry works for the mortal form, but only a full bridle suffices for the equine. The kelpie keeps the form she is bound in until she is released by her master.

Lurks

The lurk is not the most populous Thallain kith, but is by far the most adaptable. Lurks are known by many names across the world: various swamp monsters, the Bigfoot of the Pacific Northwest, the almas of central Asia, the yeti of the Himalayas, the yowie of the Australian outback, the tikoloshe of Zulu lands, the Middle Eastern barmanou, and the hibagon of Japan are but a few of the legends inspired by lurks.

Lurks are not often found outside wilderness areas, and prefer remote locations away from the prying eyes of outsiders. But changeling society and the Autumn World encroach further and further into lurk territory every year, making encounters all but inevitable. They are occasionally seen during the day, but are primarily nocturnal, preferring the cover of darkness to steal food from nets, investigate human structures, or carry off unwary victims (who are never seen again).

Lurks are not particularly intelligent, but possess animal cunning and sophisticated instincts that make them a threat to anyone intruding into their terrain. Lurks are quite adept at disguising their crime scenes as something else; many large animal attacks on deep-wilderness campsites, hunting blinds, and hiking trails are actually the work of lurks.

Appearance

Lurks are huge and sturdy, towering up to nine feet in height with heavy, muscled frames. Their fae miens are covered in hair or fur from head to toe, with large eyes, long arms, wide-flaring nostrils and a mouth full of strong teeth. Their coats typically range from brown to green to white, depending on their environment. In their mortal miens, they are unkempt, naked individuals covered with sticks, leaves, and mud. In both forms, their hands and feet are overlarge with thick, yellow nails. The big toes on either of a lurk's feet splay outward as grasping thumbs, and their walks are shambling lopes instead of true bipedal motion.

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Landscape Stride: Lurks are completely at home in their native surroundings, and receive their Glamour rating in auto-